



Faculty Post-Tenure Review
20²⁵ - 20²⁶ Academic Year

Name: Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn

Department: Department of Public Policy & Administration

Rank: Associate Professor

Date of most recent review 2018



x Tenure Promotion within tenured ranks Other post-tenure

The post-tenure review process will take place between March 15 and May 30 of each academic year in CCAS. Please see [Rutgers Policy 60.5.6](#) for the university policy on post-tenure reviews. Broadly stated, the purpose of the post-tenure review is to:

1. **Recognize** contributions and changes.
2. **Assist** in developing a plan for long-term success of faculty.
3. **Motivate** faculty members, the College, and the University to act mutually for academic excellence.
4. **Support** in building a pathway towards desired career outcomes.

The Post-Tenure Review is a process that involves both a written summary by the faculty, department chair, and the dean as well as a guided discussion.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The faculty member must complete this Faculty Post-Tenure Review Form (DocuSign preferred), attach a current CV, and submit to the department chair by **March 15**.
2. The department chair should add their comments to the form and meet with their faculty members no later than **May 30**.
3. A final signed copy with the Chair's and Dean's comments will be retained by CCAS and shared with the faculty member.

Summary of Accomplishments for the period 20¹⁸ - 20²⁵

Teaching:

see attached

Scholarship:

see attached

Service:

see attached

Click here to add additional pages



Outline of Plans and Goals for the next five years

Teaching:

see attached

Scholarship:

see attached

Service:

see attached

Additional comments on 5-year plan (for example, upcoming promotion reviews, sabbaticals, or desire for leadership engagement):

I am going up to the full professor in the current cycle.

I am happy to discuss more leadership engagement.

Click here to add additional pages



Chair's Commentary:

Teaching:

Adam has contributed to teaching in the interdisciplinary program in Data Science, of which the primary departments are Mathematics and Computer Science. He has also served as the faculty advisor for Ojobo Agbo Eje's (Data Science) Urban Innovation Fund Grant. The project focused on designing a tool to visualize health data across the city. Dr. Okulicz-Kozaryn also received the DPPA Jay A. Sigler award for outstanding service and dedication to students in 2025.

Scholarship:

Since receiving tenure and promotion to associate professor, Adam has published over 30 peer reviewed journal articles. He has a strong focus on the field of happiness and well-being studies. He regularly publishes in *Cities*, and he has published in *Social Indicators Research*, a prominent journal focused on quality of life issues. He meets expectations in terms of quantity of publications. Adam also received an external grant (\$1500) from the South Jersey Institute for Population Health (SJIPH) in 2026.

Service:

Adam has provided commendable service to the profession by serving as an ad hoc reviewer for numerous academic journals. He has also served as a co-editor for the journal *Social Indicators Research* since 2024. At the School of Arts and Sciences Camden level, Adam's Service activities have included the Appointments and Promotions committee, the Camden Faculty Senate, and chairing the Faculty Life Committee.

Additional Comments:

Please see attached labeled additional comments

Click here to add additional pages



Dean's Commentary:

Click here to add additional pages

(Sign after Review)

We have discussed the review and five-year plan as outlined.

☐ Additional faculty comments following the review meeting are attached.

Faculty Member: _____ **Date** _____

Chair: _____ **Date** _____

Dean: _____ **Date** _____

ADAM OKULICZ-KOZARYN [updated: 2026:4]

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<https://theaok.github.io>
<http://scholar.google.com/citations?hl=en&user=pz9RYIoAAAAJ>

EMPLOYMENT

Associate Professor of Public Policy, Rutgers University, the State University of New Jersey, Camden, 2018-??

Assistant Professor of Public Policy, Rutgers University, the State University of New Jersey, Camden, 2012-18

Research Scientist at Texas Schools Project (2010-11) and Clinical Assistant Professor, UT-Dallas, 2010-12

EDUCATION

Post-doctoral Fellow, Institute for Quantitative Social Science, Harvard University, 2008-10

PhD Public Policy and Political Economy, The University of Texas at Dallas, 2008

MS Corporate and Economic Policy, Poznan University of Economics (Poland), 2003

BS Banking and Finance, Poznan School of Banking (Poland), 2001

MAJOR PUBLICATIONS (all on Google Scholar; publications with students listed under service; AOK=Adam Okulicz-Kozaryn; click text for PDF)

2026 Urbanization and Happiness. A Research Agenda for Happiness. Why we want to know, what we know, and what we want to know additionally.
Editors: Jan Ott and Ruut Veenhoven. Edward Elgar Publishing

2025 AOK, Martinez L Colombia: Unlivable but Happy. Fool's Paradise? (No, a Real Paradise, Better than the US) Applied
Research in Quality of Life

2024 D'Italia M, AOK Constructing General Human Agency Indicators (GHAIs) and a General Personal Agency Scale (GPAS)
Social Indicators Research

Urban Regrets (Unhappy Metros: Satisfaction With Life Scale (SWLS)) Heliyon

2023 Magdy Zaki E, AOK, Valente RR Subjective Well-being and Urbanization in Egypt Cities

AOK, Everett B, Magdy Zaki E, Happiness is In The Air if It Grows (Growing Places are Happier than Shrinking ones) Urban
Affairs Review

2022 Unhappy Metros: Panel Evidence Applied Research in Quality of Life

AOK, Valente R, Misanthropolis: Do Cities Promote Misanthropy? Cities

2021 AOK, Valente R, Urban unhappiness is common Cities

AOK, Morawski L, A similar effect of volunteering and pensions on subjective wellbeing of elderly Economics and Sociology

2020 Valente R, AOK, Religiosity and Trust: Evidence from the United States Review of Religious Research

AOK, Valente R, The Perennial Dissatisfaction of Urban Upbringing Cities

AOK, Morawski L, Effect of volunteering and pensions on subjective wellbeing of elderly—are there cross-country differences?
Applied Research in Quality of Life

2019 Are we happier among our own race? Economics and Sociology

AOK, Altman M, The Energy Paradox: Energy Use And Happiness Applied Research in Quality of Life

2018 AOK, Valente R, No Urban Malaise for Millennials Regional Studies

2017 AOK, Valente R, Livability and Subjective Wellbeing Across European Cities Applied Research in Quality of Life

Strzelecka M, AOK, Is tourism conducive to residents' social trust? Evidence from large-scale surveys. Tourism Review

AOK, Valente R, Life Satisfaction of Career Women and Housewives Applied Research in Quality of Life

AOK, Valente R, City Life: Glorification, Desire, and the Unconscious Size Fetish, ed. by I Kapoor, in Psychoanalysis and the Global, University of Nebraska Press

AOK, Golden L, Happiness is flextime Applied Research in Quality of Life

2016 AOK, Strzelecka M, Happy Tourists, Unhappy Locals Social Indicators Research

Happiness Research for Public Policy and Administration Transforming Government: People, Process and Policy

Unhappy Metropolis (When American City Is Too Big) Cities

AOK, Mazelis J M, More Unequal in Income, More Unequal in WellBeing Social Indicators Research

AOK, Mazelis J M, Urbanism and Happiness: A Test of Wirth's Theory of Urban Life Urban Studies

2015 Freedom and Life Satisfaction in Transition Society and Economy

AOK, Nash T, Tursi N O, Luxury Car Owners Are Not Happier Than Frugal Car Owners International Review of Economics

The More Religiosity, the Less Creativity Across US Counties Business Creativity & the Creative Economy

Income Inequality and Wellbeing Applied Research in Quality of Life

!!!: this book is excluded from the promotion packet (this is a popular science book) Happiness and Place: Cities v Nature. Why Life is Better Outside of the City? Palgrave Macmillan

2014 AOK, Holmes IV O, Avery D R, The Subjective Well-Being Political Paradox: Happy Welfare States and Unhappy Liberals
Journal of Applied Psychology

Winners and Losers in Transition: Preferences For Redistribution and Nostalgia For Communism In Eastern Europe
Kyklos

'Freedom From' and 'Freedom To' across countries Social Indicators Research

Natural Sprawl Administration & Society (Disputatio Sine Fine section) (section of the journal reviewed by editor only)

2013 Cluttered Writing: Adjectives and Adverbs in Academia Scientometrics

City Life: Rankings (Livability) vs Perceptions (Satisfaction) Social Indicators Research

2012 Does Religious Diversity Make Us Unhappy? Mental Health, Religion & Culture

Income and Well-being across European Provinces Social Indicators Research

2011 Berry B J L, AOK, An Urban-Rural Happiness Gradient Urban Geography

Geography of European Life Satisfaction Social Indicators Research

Europeans Work To Live and Americans Live To Work (Who is Happy to Work More: Americans or Europeans?)

Journal of Happiness Studies

2010 Religiosity and Life Satisfaction Across Nations Mental Health, Religion & Culture

2009 Berry B J L, AOK, Dissatisfaction with City Life: A New Look at Some Old Questions Cities

EXTERNAL GRANTS

190k PLN (~\$50k) PI, "The effect of social transfers and social capital on happiness of elderly." Vistula University, Warsaw Poland, Polish National Science Foundation (Narodowe Centrum Nauki NCN) 2016/21/B/HS4/03058 .. 2017-2019

\$1.5k Consultant (summer salary), "Health information inequity in South Jersey-Vineland" South Jersey Institute for Population Health (SJIPH) Catalyst Grant <https://sjiph.org/projects/health-information-inequity-in-south-jersey-vineland> 2026

INTERNAL GRANTS (AWARDS and FELLOWSHIPS)

\$12k faculty advisor, Rutgers Camden chancellor's dissertation completion award for Marlo Rossi2026

\$30k faculty advisor, Rutgers Camden urban innovation fund grant to Ojobo Agbo Eje2024-2026

\$15k PI, Rutgers Camden chancellor's interdisciplinary research collaboration grant 2023-2024

\$1k Rutgers-Camden Research Council Grant Award 2016-2017

\$1k Rutgers-Camden Digital Teaching Fellow 2016-2017

\$4k Rutgers-Camden Rand Institute Faculty Fellow 2013-2014

\$1k Rutgers-Camden Civic Engagement Faculty Fellow 2013-2014

TEACHING (note curriculum development: [developed/designed] or [re-designed])

2025 recipient of department's Jay A Sigler award for "outstanding service and dedication to students" (awarded by students); the plaque says "this award is given to the faculty member who exhibits a commitment to student's academic development and personal growth."

GIS for data science <https://theaok.github.io/gisPy/> [developed/designed] 2023-present

Data Processing (data management for data science) <https://theaok.github.io/datManPy> [developed/designed] 2023-present

Data Visualization <https://theaok.github.io/vis> [developed/designed] 2023-present

Coping with Extremes: Ecological resilience & human well-being [innovative class co-taught with biology dept] [co-developed/designed] 2019

Community & WellBeing (Happiness and Place) [developed/designed]	2018-present
Data Management [developed/designed]	2016-present
GIS for Public Sector/Urban mapping [developed/designed]	2012-present
Quantitative Methods 2 [re-designed]	2013-2017, 2024
Research Methods [re-designed]	2012-present
Introduction to Regional and Economic Development [re-designed]	2012-2014
Quantitative Methods 1 [re-designed]	2012-2013

SERVICE

SERVICE TO THE FIELD/PROFESSION:

Review papers (approx 3-4/mo or 36-48/year as of Jan 2026; “top journals” underlined; starting in 2022: last 2 digits of year of review shown):

- <informal/for a colleague> [24]
- Acta Sociologica
- Applied Economics [23,23]
- Applied Research in Quality of Life [23,23,23,24,24,24,24,26]
- Basic and Applied Social Psychology [22]
- BMC Psychology [26]
- BMJ Open
- British Journal of Political Science [25]
- Cities [22,23,23,23,23,23,24,24,24,24,24,25,25,25,25,25,25,25,25]
- City, Culture and Society
- City, Territory and Architecture [24]
- Cogent Arts & Humanities [23]
- Cognition and Emotion
- Communications Psychology [23]
- Comparative Economic Studies [26]
- Discover Public Health [25,26]
- Ecological Economics [24]
- Environment and Planning A
- Economics and Politics
- European Journal of Social Psychology
- European Journal of Political Economy [23,23,24]
- European Societies
- European Urban and Regional Studies [22,22]
- Frontiers in Psychology [23]
- Global Transitions [24]
- Humanities and Social Sciences Communications [23,23,23,24,24,25,25]
- Heliyon [23,24]
- International Journal of Comparative Sociology [23,24,24,25]

- International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health
- International Journal of Psychology
- International Journal of Social Economics [22]
- International Journal of Wellbeing [25]
- International Perspectives in Psychology: Research, Practice, Consultation
- International Sociology
- Journal of Comparative Economics
- Journal of Contemporary Religion
- Journal of Economic Growth
- Journal of Economic Psychology
- Journal of Economic and Social Geography
- Journal of Personality and Social Psychology: Personality Processes and Individual Differences[16]
- Journal of Personality and Social Psychology: Attitudes and Social Cognition[26]
- Journal of Religion and Health
- Journal of Regional Science
- Journal of Happiness Studies [22,23,24,26,26,26]
- Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Management
- Journal of Public and Nonprofit Affairs
- Journal of Public Policy [23,23]
- Journal of the American Planning Association
- Journal of Urbanism
- Land Use Policy [23,24,24]
- Local Development and Society [25]
- Mental Health, Religion and Culture
- Millah: Journal of Religious Studies [25]
- Nature Communications [24]
- Open Psychology Journal
- Quality of Life Research
- Papers in Regional Science [22,22]
- PLOS ONE [22]
- Political Behavior [22]
- PNAS Nexus [24]
- Problems of Post-Communism [22]
- Psychology of Religion and Spirituality
- Public Administration Review [24,25]
- Regional Studies [22,22]
- Review of Political Economy
- Routledge (book publisher) [22]
- Rural Sociology [22]
- Urban Geography
- Urban Studies [25]
- Urban Affairs Review
- Utilities Policy [25,25]
- Science of the Total Environment

- Scientific Reports [24]
- Scienze Regionali Italian Journal of Regional Science
- Scientometrics [22,22]
- Semestre Economico (Universidad de Medellín) [22]
- Social Forces
- Social Psychological and Personality Science
- Social Indicators Research [as reviewer] [22,22,23,23,23,23,24,24,24,24,25,25,25,25]
- Social Indicators Research [as co-editor]¹ [25, 25, 25, 25, 25]
- Social Science And Medicine [24,24,25,25,25,25]
- Social Science Research [23]
- Social Sciences & Humanities Open [23]
- Sociological Spectrum
- Sociology of Religion
- Sustainability
- Sustainable Cities and Society
- Sustainable Futures [25]
- The Lancet Planetary Health (IF >10)
- Third World Quarterly [22,23]
- Wellbeing, Space & Society [22,25]

Reviewed books chapters:

- 3 chapters in “A Research Agenda for Happiness. Why we want to know, what we know, and what we want to know additionally.” Editors: Jan Ott and Ruut Veenhoven. Edward Elgar Publishing [26,26,26]

Reviewed books for:

- Routledge [22]
- Cambridge U Pr [23]

Served on editorial boards:

- Social Indicators Research: Associate Editor / Co-Editor² Jan 2024-??
- Political Behavior Jan-Dec 2019

Reviewed grant proposals:

- Polish National Science Foundation (NCN)
- Israel Science Foundation (ISF)

SERVICE TO STUDENTS:

Publications with students (all students unless indicated: “[not student]”):

9. AOK, L Martinez [not student], E Mikhaeil; Happy Colombia, Unhappy Bogota (urban-rural happiness gradient in Colombia) Wellbeing, Space and Society 2026
8. E Mikhaeil, AOK; Well-Being and the authoritarian welfare state: sector of employment and human happiness in Arab countries; Public Organization Review 2025

¹As a co-editor of Social Indicators Research, conducted through reviews (printed out, marked up, etc). Note: this is different from regular editing, where I just skim through the paper or read some parts only; and hence this extra work is listed here separately from editing as reviewing [starting oct2025 each such review marked with 2 last digits of year]

²This is not just sitting on the board of the journal and having an occasional board meeting, I am editing papers every week spending as of 2026 $1 + hrs/wk$ (earlier as i was less experienced it was $2 + hrs/wk$) on skimming through the submitted manuscripts, inviting reviewers, reading reviews, and making editorial decisions.

7. MJ D'Italia, AOK; Constructing General Human Agency Indicators (GHAls) and a General Personal Agency Scale (GPAS); Social Indicators Research 2025
6. E Mikhaeil, AOK; Public-private job satisfaction differential: The case of Egypt; Public Organization Review 2025
5. AOK, BK Everett, E Mikhaeil; Happiness is In The Air if It Grows (Growing Places are Happier than Shrinking ones); Urban Affairs Review 2024
4. E Mikhaeil, AOK; Subjective well-being and urbanization in Egypt; Cities 2024
3. S Deb, AOK; Exploring the association of urbanization and subjective well-being in India; Cities 2023
2. FA Abarghuie, R Javadi, E Mirabi, AOK; Experience of urban thermal pleasure: A qualitative study to the understanding of thermal-scape quality; Cities 2022
1. R Stansfield [not student], E Aaronson, AOK; Police use of firearms: Exploring citizen, officer, and incident characteristics in a statewide sample; Journal of criminal justice 2021

Supervised dissertations for [year of graduation, first job]:

8. Wei Chen [28??]
7. Erick W Udogu [27??]
6. Douglas N Zacher [27??]
5. Marlo Rossi [26??]
4. Michael D'Italia [24, RU-Camden] PDF
3. Shibin Yan [24, Walter Rand Institute for Public Affairs] PDF
2. Aditi Manke [21, Virginia Tech] PDF
1. Shourjya Deb [20, SIPRI] PDF

Supervised dissertations for less than the whole duration:

1. Helena Cabezas [Fall 25 only]

Served on dissertation committees:

10. Jason Schweitzer (Prevention Science) [27??]
9. Daniel Assamah [27??]
8. Monty Sanders [26??]
7. Brian Everett [27??]
6. Kate Cruz [22]
5. Charles Ian Hugh Forsyth (University of Otago NZ) [22]
4. Straso Jovanovski [19]
3. Spencer Clayton [18]
2. Rasheda Weaver [17]
1. Chris Wheeler [17]

Served on dissertation committees for less than the whole duration:

1. Yanan Li [stopped serving just before the proposal in 2023]

Supervised data science master thesis for [year of graduation]:

6. Nalluri Chandahas [26]
5. Bhavyani Dodda [25]
4. Thanvitha Reddy Munagala [25]
3. Pavan Satya Venigalla [25]
2. Het Rakeshbhai Patel [25]
1. Raman Srinivas Naik [25]

Served on master thesis committees in social science:

2. Ethan Aaronson (crim) [20]
1. Rachel Wagner (psy) [20]

Independent/Directed Study [starting in 2023 counts shown (2014-present)]:

- fa25 x1
- sp25 x4
- fa24 x7
- sp24 x2
- fa23 x1

Researchers/Predocs/Postdocs/Lab Members/Visiting Scholars:

- hired 2 data scientists (Sep 2025-Jul 2026)
- planning to host Visiting Scholar, Professor Leonie C. Steckermeier Fall 2026

DEPARTMENTAL AND CAMPUS-WIDE SERVICE:

At Rutgers-Camden served on the following departmental committees:

- Awards/Events, chair 2013-16, 2021-22; 2023-25
- Awards/Events, member 2012-13, 2019-20, 2023
- Strategic Planning, member 2019-20
- PR/Website, chair 2014-16
- PR/Website, member 2012-13
- PhD, member 2014-21
- Methods Qualifying Exam, member 2012-21

Other Rutgers-Camden departmental service:

- held dissertation seminars for a group of doctoral candidates (in addition to one-on-one) Fall 2025
- led Brown Bag Seminars 2018-19; 2023-24
- As co-editor of a journal organized “Publish or Perish” workshop Oct 2024

At Rutgers-Camden served on the following campus-wide committees:

- AI committee Fall 2025
- Advancement and Promotions (A&P), member/ad hoc chair 2020-25
- Advancement and Promotions (A&P), member 2018-19
- Faculty Senate 2018-25
- Faculty Life, chair 2019-22
- Faculty Life, member 2014-15

Other Rutgers-Camden campus-wide service:

- led creation and maintenance of data science lab and MS in data science and associated certificate programs 2018-22
- served as director for data science certificate: <https://graduateschool.camden.rutgers.edu/graduate-programs/#certificates> 2022-??
- organized Geographic Information System (GIS) workshop attended by faculty from across the campus <https://theaok.github.io/shortGIS/> 2017

COMMUNITY SERVICE

provided data management for:

- Ohio Business Round Table (contracted by Miami University, Ohio; Contract Amount: \$7,000) 2022
- 2018 Michigan Economic Competitiveness Study, Michigan Chamber of Commerce (contracted by Northwood University, Michigan; Contract Amount: \$5,000) 2018

assisted following Rutgers-Camden students in their community projects as a faculty advisor:

- data science MS Ojobo Agbo Eje: "Camden Health Equity Data Visualization Initiative" project: [click for news item] [hired/supervised 4 students, budget \$30k] 2024-26
- public affairs PhD Zach Chengcheng Yue at Walter Rand Institute: Covid-19 in Atlantic County ... Spring-Fall 2025
- public affairs PhD Marlo Rossi at Walter Rand Institute: Abortion in South Jersey; and other projects on abortion: [click for news item] Fall 2025-Spring 2026
- MPA Olorunfunmi Adebajo's internship at the Camden County Community Development Office's Homelessness Assistance Unit: [click for news item], 2024

other community service:

- made GIS maps dashboard (containing work by students in my GIS class): available on campus or via RU VPN only: <https://maps-dppa.camden.rutgers.edu/index.php?search=map&title=Special%3ASearch&profile=default&fulltext=1> 2019-23
- assisted Hunterdon Central Regional High School student: happiness paper class project Fall 2025-Spring 2026
- organized Geographic Information System (GIS) workshop for The Walter Rand Institute for Public Affairs <https://theaok.github.io/shortGIS/vShortGeoda.pdf> 2019

MOST FREQUENT RECENT CONFERENCES

LASA (Latin American Studies Association) 2024

AAG (American Association of Geographers): 2015, 2016, 2017, covid19/none,

ISQOLS (International Society for Quality of Life Studies): 2015, 2017, 2018, covid19/none, 2023, 2024 (webinar), 2026 (regional)

ERSA (European Regional Science Association): 2015, 2017, 2018, covid19/none, 2023

AFFILIATE SCHOLAR

- Australian Centre on Quality of Life (2016-present)
- CURE: Center for Urban Research and Education, Rutgers-Camden (2012-18)
- EHERO: Erasmus Happiness Economics Research Organization, Erasmus, the Netherlands (2013-16)
- Vistula University, Warsaw, Poland (2015-18)

1 Research

Since 2017, when I have submitted my materials for promotion to associate professor with tenure, I have published 36 peer reviewed articles, including 7 in *Cities*, a journal with impact factor (IF)=7.8, higher than widely considered the top journal in public administration in the US, *Public Administration Review* with IF=6.2.¹ Four articles are in *Social Indicators Research* (out of which 1 provisionally accepted/minor revisions), and 9 in *Applied Research in Quality of Life*, both leading/main journals in my field.

2 Teaching

I am 2025 recipient of the department's Jay A Sigler award for "outstanding service and dedication to students" (awarded by students); the plaque says "this award is given to the faculty member who exhibits a commitment to student's academic development and personal growth."

Since 2020, I graduated 4 PhDs, they all have a job. One is at SIPRI (Stockholm International Peace Research Institute), a think-tank ranked 11th or 31st worldwide.² Another one at Virginia Tech and the other 2 were employed at Rutgers when they graduated.

My students publish. Since 2020, I have published 10 peer-reviewed papers with my students (9 published and 1 provisionally accepted/minor revisions) in good journals including 3 in top ranked *Cities* with Impact Factor of 7.8.

I make sure I am available and approachable for students spending extra time outside of the classroom: working on papers, being accessible via zoom and in person, including when on sabbatical. Now in Spring 2026 I am on sabbatical, but I still have 4 students enrolled in my dissertation hours, and I work with others on papers.

One highlight is unusually heavy curriculum development. Since coming to Rutgers-Camden in 2012, I have taught over 10 different classes, developed from scratch most of them, including 3 courses in 2023 for our new data science program. I am updating my teaching materials each time I teach a class.

I strive to improve my teaching: I just attended cybersecurity training (most of my teaching is computer coding or data science—cybersecurity matters there), and attended Instructional Design and Technology (IDT) workshop on "Crafting the Learner-Centered Syllabus" in 2024. And I quite regularly read on teaching and mentoring advice, tips and tricks on *nature.com*, *chronicle.com*, and *insidehighered.com*.

One highlight is that the skills learned in my classes work in the real world:

The classes I took with you are helping not only my scholarship, but my day job. Thank you [...]
I greatly appreciate it.

Subject: Received a Job Offer [...] I would like to thank you for all of the guidance and knowledge during all of your data-related courses the past several semesters to help me get to the point I am at today.

Since graduating I have continued to pursue more projects in the coding world. Some analysis projects, business models, and even some fun web apps and game designs. I appreciate all the help and motivation you gave me in class as it helped me to really see what I can come up with from

¹<https://www.scimagojr.com/journalsearch.php?q=16956&tip=sid> and <https://www.scimagojr.com/journalsearch.php?q=17167&tip=sid>

²<https://thinktankalert.com/rankings> and <https://guides.library.upenn.edu/c.php?g=1035991&p=7509972>

all of the useful tools, how to plan and build on projects, and skills gained from having you as my professor.

And students appreciate my approach and style:

I am reaching out to explore the possibility of having you as my graduate advisor. My experience in your Data Management course left a lasting impression on me and I appreciated your approach and teaching style. I believe your guidance would be invaluable in helping me navigate the academic journey towards finishing my doctoral degree.

This is Teacher Appreciation Week and I just wanted to take a moment to say thank you for all the hard work and dedication you put into teaching. Your passion for education has inspired and impacted me in so many ways. Your commitment to helping your students grow and learn is truly admirable. Thank you for all that you do!

Please know that I deeply appreciate everything you have done for me, and I recognize the many ways you have helped me grow as a scholar and, frankly, as an agentic person in general. I am truly grateful for you.

And my classes might have even contributed to retention in the program:

I have learnt so much about my region is really unbelievable and I have enjoyed working with you a lot. So much, I am actually considering STAYING in the program because of you!

3 Service

My service mostly builds on and derives from my main focus and strength, research. I provide such service in two main ways: 1) to the profession/scholarly field, and 2) to students.

I review about 3-4/mo or 36-48/year papers for journals, including the top journals such as Journal of Personality and Social Psychology and Public Administration Review (see CV for details).

Reviewing is an essential foundation of scholarly fields, and it is increasingly in short supply—something I can attest as a journal editor. Since January 2024, I co-edit Social Indicators Research, the leading journal in my field of quality of life and wellbeing. My editorial philosophy is to be mentor and helper, not just gate-keeper—for instance, I am often in favor of revision prior to external review, and I try to guide the authors, especially the junior ones.

My research-oriented service over past 6 years 2020-2026 to students is: published 10 peer-reviewed articles with students as co-authors (9 published and 1 provisionally accepted/minor revisions), supervised 8 dissertations (4 graduated; 4 in-progress), served on 6 dissertation committees, supervised 6 data science master theses, served on 2 master thesis committees in other social science, and supervised 15 independent studies. I have also led brown bag seminars and organized a workshop on academic publishing.

And I am very excited about bringing to campus an award winning junior professor from Germany as a visiting scholar for 2 months in Fall 2026: Leonie C. Steckermeier. Leonie is a productive scholar already benefiting 2 of our doctoral students—we have monthly or so zoom meetings where we are already working on papers.

I contribute service to the campus and department. Over 2018-2022 I have led the development of a new MS in data science and associated certificate program. This was a substantial undertaking and also somewhat challenging as the newly created programs are located outside of my home department. I have been serving since 2022 as a director for data science certificate.³

³See certificates at the bottom of the page: <https://graduateschool1.camden.rutgers.edu/graduate-programs>.

I am currently supervising 2 courtesy appointments as volunteer researchers in the department—they work with me on research but also helped students in my class. I frequently serve as either ad hoc chair or member on the Advancement and Promotions (A&P) committee. I find this service fulfilling. I contribute to promoting quality faculty in our social sciences and I learn about my colleagues. Other committee service is enumerated in the CV.

While research-oriented service is my strength and passion, and usual campus and departmental service is my duty, I am also mindful of Rutgers-Camden public/community service/engagement mission. I agree that as a public university, we also need to engage with and provide service to the public and community. I have assisted a number of Rutgers-Camden students in their community projects over past 5 years serving as a faculty advisor for, for instance: Olorunfunmi Adebajo's internship at the Camden County Community Development Office's Homelessness Assistance Unit,⁴ Marlo Rossi's project at Walter Rand Institute and other projects on abortion,⁵ and Ojobo Agbo Eje: "Camden Health Equity Data Visualization Initiative."⁶

New Jersey first, but I have been civically engaged outside of the Garden State as well. For instance, I have used my data management skills to assist with data collection and management for Ohio Business Round Table, and Michigan Economic Competitiveness Study.

⁴Click for news item.

⁵Click for news item.

⁶Click for news item.

1 Research

The near future trajectory goal remains similar: ≥ 3 papers per year in good journals. In addition to European and North American focus I plan to add Latin American focus. I plan to spend more time on grant writing as I plan to grow my research group, hire students and post-docs, and do course buy-outs.

2 Teaching

My feature teaching preference would be to continue with the classes I have already taught, and there are plenty of them, over 10. My strength and preference is data science classes, but also happiness class that aligns with my research. I have been also developing a new class “social indicators” that would be broader than just happiness and include topics such as trust, freedom, and meaning. This would also align with my editorial position at Social Indicators Research journal.

I am interested in teaching short courses / micro-credentials. I have already taught a short GIS course (<https://theaok.github.io/shortGIS/>) twice, informally, for my colleagues from the department and other faculty from Arts and Sciences, and for Walter Rand Institute. But I would like to teach more often and other short courses. There is an initiative to create micro-credentials and Digital Badges—I would like to participate in it.

3 Service

In the ideal world, I would like to continue with research-oriented service. In particular, I would like to increase my research group and co-author more with students, and ideally postdocs. Chairing more dissertations and leading more independent studies would also be my strength and preference. I'm happy to take on more administrative duties such as co-editing another journal.

Additional comments:

On the face of it this is a good record. However, there are underlying problems with Adam's performance. Specifically, Adam has been very contentious in his interactions with faculty in the department. He has threatened to sue 3 faculty members in the department. His threats have strained working relationships in the department. This makes it extremely difficult for Adam to work with faculty members at lower ranks; at the same rank, but with fewer years of service; and even full professors. Adam also threatened to hold up a PhD student's proposal over a methodological dispute with the committee chair.

Teaching: As a result of Adam's behavior, I have only one full professor that Adam has not threatened. I assigned this professor to conduct Adam's peer observation. Adam resisted allowing the faculty member to conduct the observation and delayed the process.

After multiple email exchanges, Adam finally complied with the classroom observation. However, he sent an email to the observer prior to the observation stating:

Pls don't disturb the class or interrupt or say anything in the class.

I'm happy to have this visitation in the spirit of collegiality, but please note I have concerns about your evaluations from the past as non-factual, unreasonable, and unfair.

Also please note you are not my mentor, and I'm not trying to learn anything from you.

This behavior is unacceptable. Adam needs to collaborate with the peer observers in the department. He also needs to reflect on the feedback provided and develop an action plan for improvement in areas identified by the observer.

In addition, student comments on Adam's SIRS reports indicate that his approach to teaching could be more organized. Sample comments include (see attachment for comprehensive list):

- This course needs a clear and complete syllabus as well as clear assignment instructions and an overall grading scale or rubrics for each assignment.
- Provide students with a grading rubric and clear expectations. Provide clear instructions for assignments.
- Better organize the syllabus and slides
- Needs to be better organized
- Not having a clear syllabus document and one central course page on one platform made it extremely hard to keep track of class assignments and progress
- Course needs a structured, organized Canvas site; the course website is confusing and difficult to navigate.

I recommend that Adam make an appointment with Camden IDT to get assistance with revising his syllabi and building effective Canvas sites for his courses.

I previously spoke with Adam about the following courses: GIS, Data Management, and Data Visualization. Adam has pivoted to using only Python in these courses. His rationale is as follows:

- “Python is the future of coding, QGIS may disappear”
- He can’t teach 2 different methods in the same class
- When DPPA and data science courses are cross-listed, he goes with the majority of students (e.g., data science)
- Since these courses are electives, he doesn’t see the need to make adjustments.

His syllabi use the following phrases:

- students need to have “the ability to learn basic coding”
- “if you have difficulty using a computer, this class is not for you”
- “warning if you can’t learn simple coding in Python, this class is not for you.

This language does not create a welcoming environment for DPPA students. Although, he previously used QGIS for the course GIS in the Public Sector and Stata for the MPA/Public Affairs version of Data Management, he stated he will no longer provide alternatives to Python in these courses. He also stated that Data Visualization is all Python.

This approach poses problems because it makes his courses inaccessible to some of our DPPA students. Adam seems indifferent to their needs. Lengthier comments from SIRS include:

Research Methods Fall 2021

There was absolutely no encouragement for intellectual growth and progress. If you did not come up with what the professor would have for an assignment you got an extremely poor grade with little or unhelpful feedback. Most other professors grade problem sets based on completion and effort and give helpful feed back for later, larger and graded assignments (i.e. midterms and finals).

Spending hours on complicated and unclear problem sets and reviewing them multiple times to ensure all questions were answered and then getting 3/10 grades is extremely discouraging and extremely unhelpful. This course is also the course that leads into our capstone projects but in this class we had no freedom in our research approaches and were only being taught extremely numerical, statistical, and quantitative methods with no mention of or real option for other very important research methods especially for those on the community development track.

The course materials on the professors private website were so disorganized and hard to follow. Having to look for an unclear and unorganized syllabus one place and then having to submit our assignment another place (Canvas) and then access dropbox on Sakai for feed back was extremely confusing and frustrating. Not having a clear syllabus document and one central course page on one platform made it extremely hard to keep track of class assignments and progress and to stay motivated as a person who needs structure to be successful. I have never experienced anything like this and it was extremely frustrating and stressful to navigate. It was such a shame this was the experience in this class as this is an extremely important course in our program and for our capstone.

Data Management Fall 2023

I wanted to be excited for this course, but he made it unapproachable and painful. He seemed to assume the answers to students' questions were obvious and would say "look at my notes" when students requested clarification. His notes were extremely minimal and often vague. I don't know if it occurs to him that the material he's teaching is not intuitive to people who haven't coded before. Frankly the course should not be offered to those who do not already have experience with python.

This instructor needs to learn basic pedagogy. I cannot overstate that. I never learned from a single lecture and I found office hours unhelpful as well. The instructor's communication skills and teaching skills in general make him difficult to approach. I eventually gave up on trying. Everything that I learned from this course I did on my own time by talking to graduate students in the computer science program. I have never left a review this negative before for an instructor. I am uncomfortable stating all of this, but I think it needs to be said. I would never have taken this course if I knew how it was run. I would actively discourage other students from taking this course unless it changes drastically.

Adam has been very dedicated to teaching the data science classes, but he seems indifferent to the needs of DPPA students. In addition to consulting with IDT, I recommend that Adam work with Bill Fitzgerald and other teaching mentors on the Camden Campus to address the issues highlighted above.

I would like to see Adam make a stronger contribution to teaching in his home department. Specifically, it would be helpful to have Adam take responsibility for the Regional and Economic Development course in the MS/PhD program and possibly one of the core PhD courses.

Service: Although Adam's service to the discipline and the Camden campus is good, I would like to see a stronger level of service to the department. Several DPPA faculty members have heavy service loads as program and center directors. As a result, we need Adam to take a stronger role in supporting the department. In his previous service on the Public Affairs committee with comprehensive exams, he submitted questions that had been posted online and could not be used. He appeared to put little time or effort into his work on the MS/PHD committee.

There are opportunities to take on a greater leadership role in several areas, including:

- Advising doctoral students
- Guiding dissertations and working collaboratively with other committee members
- Assisting the department with:
 - data dashboards
 - graduation rates for students,
 - data collection,
 - assisting with data from affiliated centers
- Workshops for PhD Students
- Data Mentoring

In his current role as Chair of the Awards and Events Committee, Adam needs to pay more attention to details. For example, in organizing the practice sessions for students participating in the UAA conference, he needs to clearly communicate the expectations and details of the practice sessions and coordinate multiple email reminders.

In the past, Adam has been enthusiastic about organizing brown bag presentations with graduate students. It would be helpful for him to re-engage with this practice. This aligns with his role as chair of the Awards & Events Committee. As noted above, he needs to take initiative in scheduling and communicating expectations/details of the events with faculty and graduate students.

Research: Although this is a good record, there is room for improvement in a variety of areas. In terms of research, Adam's research on cities would have more added value if he could speak to what leads to or causes unhappiness in cities. For example, is it density, diversity, or something else? What are the policy implications? In addition, it would be helpful to secure external grants and leverage internal grants/awards to fund his research, especially his Colombia project. It would also be helpful to have a clearer explanation of what his future research plans are.